were accused wrongly of being Communists simply because they were liberals.

As the news spread of Moscow's attempted takeover of Hollywood, the glamour of the movie business and the people who worked in it made it a popular target for people in politics who wanted publicity for themselves. And some of them abused the powers of their office to get it. I was all for kicking Communists out of Hollywood, but some members of the House Un-American Activities Committee, ignoring standards of truth and fair play, ganged up on innocent people and tried to blacklist them.

Jimmy Cagney and Humphrey Bogart and other good Americans were accused falsely of being Communists. Petitions landed in Hollywood from around the country signed by thousands of people who declared they would not go to a theater if—and they listed dozens of Hollywood stars—certain people were in a movie. The thing had gotten out of hand.

We faced a dilemma: Olivia de Havilland and others with whom I had become close were determined to get rid of the Communists, but we had to protect the people who were innocent. To deal with the problem, we formed an industry council to contact people in the industry who were being threatened with blacklisting—including many who didn't know they were—and said to them: "Look, we can't clear you, but we can help you clear yourself."

We urged them to publicly declare their opposition to Communism and to volunteer to appear before the FBI and the House Un-American Activities Committee—two things no Communist could agree to. We would arrange their meetings and we would vouch for their innocence.

If on the other hand, someone said, "I won't do that," we simply said: "We can't help you."

The system allowed people to clear themselves and it worked, it really worked. The industry and the public